Thread
414K views

lennox_saint 03/22/26

i got Claude to watch 24 months of Diary of a CEO's YouTube videos so you don't have to.

here's the data-backed guide to going viral: 1/9

● Diary Of A CEO YouTube Research Corpus — Complete

Asset	Count	Status
Videos indexed	205	100%
Transcripts	205/205	100%
Thumbnails	205/205	100%
Metadata dossiers	205	100%
Feature extraction	205	100%
Analysis reports	11	Complete
Constitutions	5 markdown + JSON + YAML	Complete
Evidence cross-refs	4	Complete

1.2K 157 115 606

Top View activity

lennox_saint 03/22/26

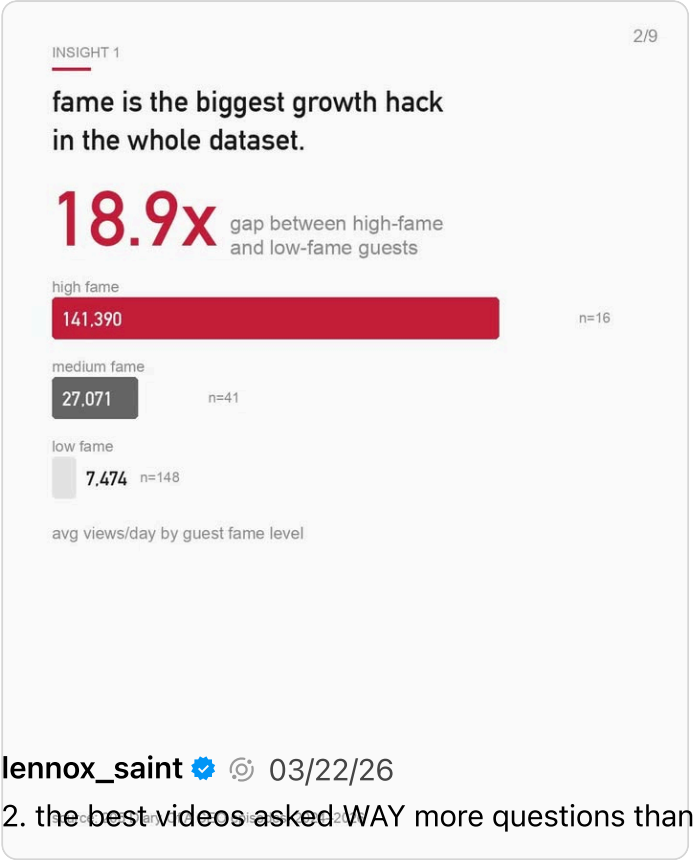
1. fame is the biggest growth hack for you

high-fame guests averaged 141,390 views/day. low-fame guests averaged 7,474. that's an 18.9x gap, and low-fame guests STILL made up 148 of the 205 episodes(!)

@steven you need to know this.

Threads takeaway:

borrow demand with known people (like i did with this thread), known conflicts, or known stories. 2/9



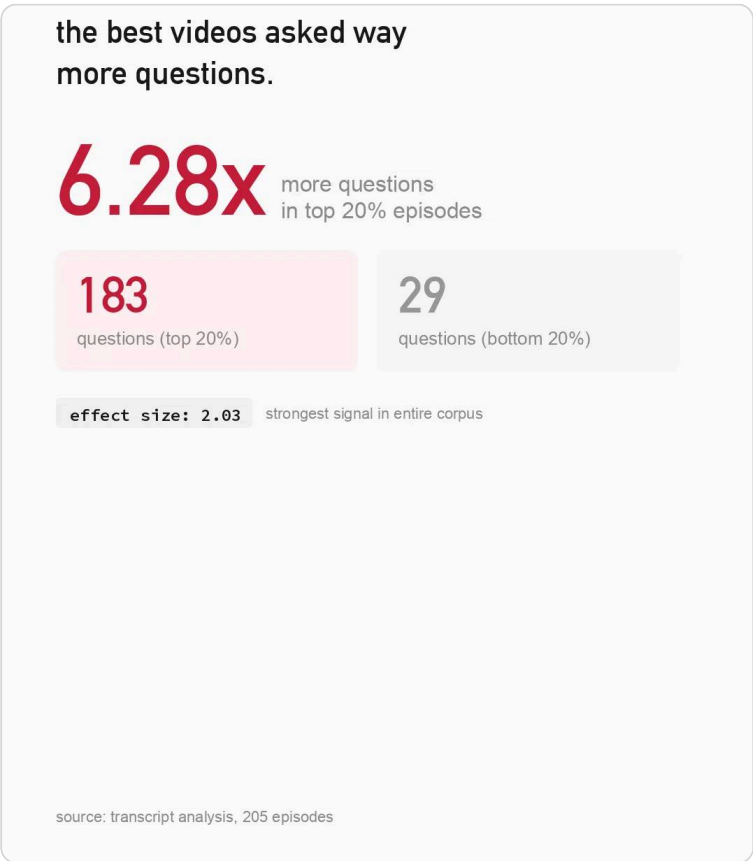
lennox_saint 03/22/26

2. the best videos asked WAY more questions than the worst ones.

top-20% interviews averaged 182.9 questions. bottom-20% interviews averaged 29.1. that's a 6.28x gap and an effect size of 2.03, which is fkn massive.

Threads takeaway:

script more curiosity pivots. every new question is a new retention hook. 3/9



55 1 1 1

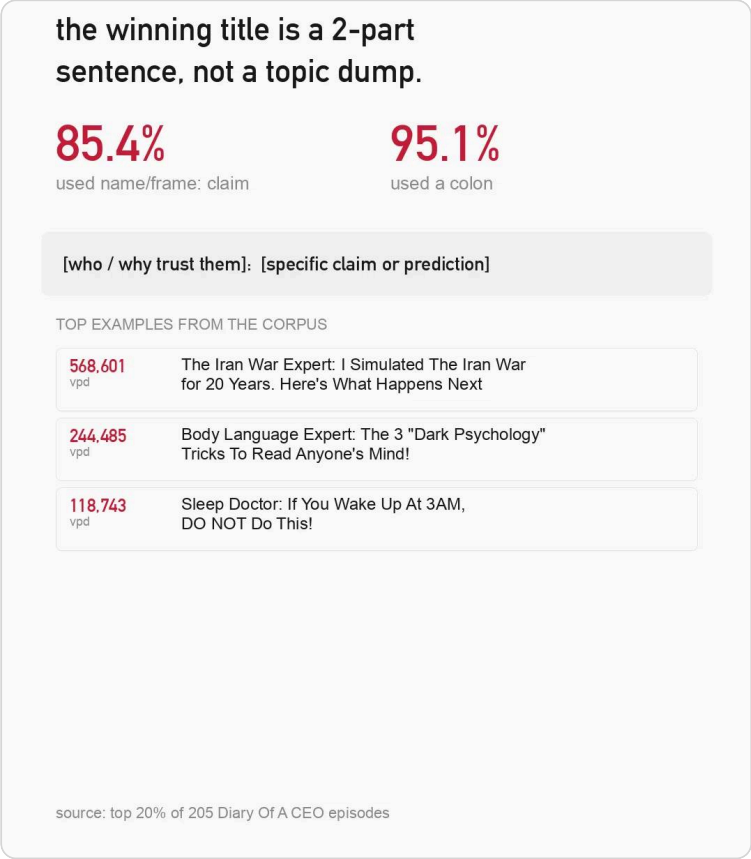
lennox_saint 03/22/26

3. the winning title was a 2-part sentence, not a topic dump.

85.4% of the top videos used a name/frame: claim structure. 95.1% of top videos used a colon. the pattern was simple: credibility or name first, then the payoff.

Threads takeaway:

try this template tomorrow: [who/why trust this]: [specific consequence or prediction]. 4/9



59 3 1 4

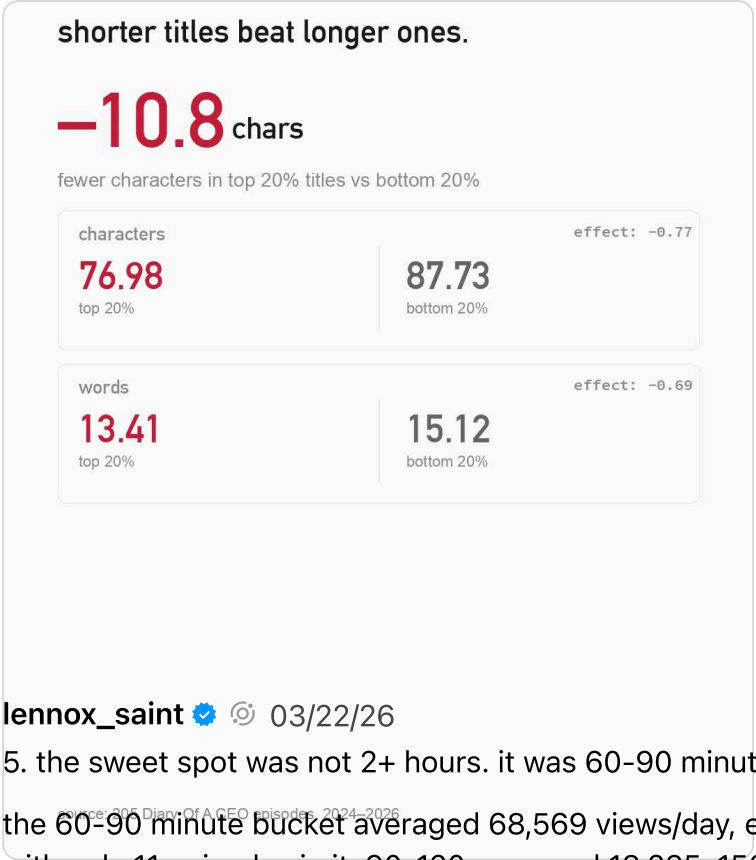
lennox_saint 03/22/26

4. shorter titles beat longer ones, even on a long-form podcast channel.

the top 20% averaged 76.9 characters and 13.4 words. the bottom 20% averaged 87.7 characters and 15.1 words. winning titles were shorter by 10.7 characters.

Threads takeaway:

nail your first 5 words. they're everything. 5/9



lennox_saint 03/22/26

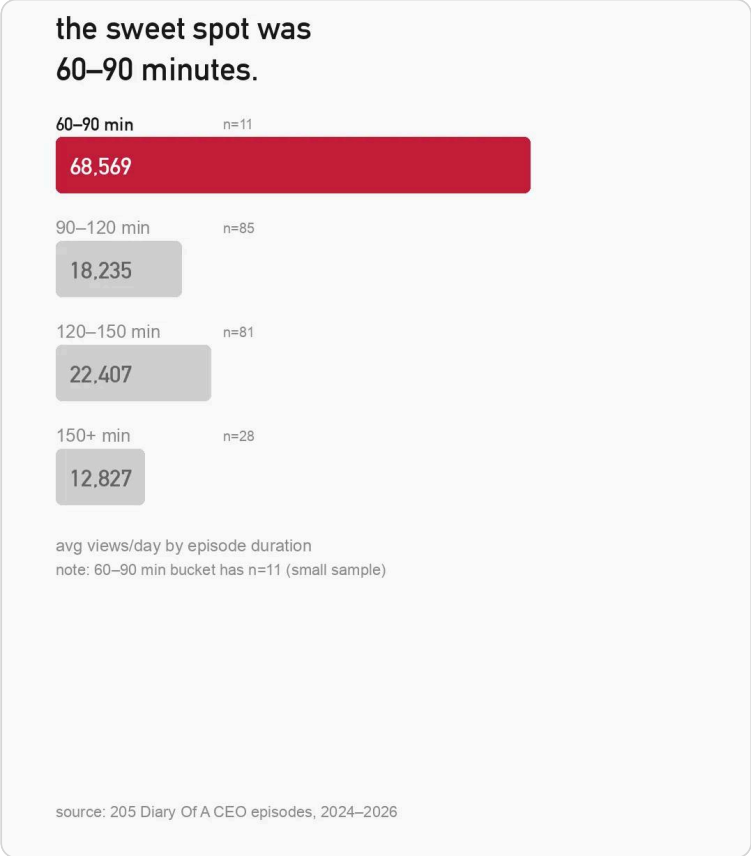
5. the sweet spot was not 2+ hours. it was 60-90 minutes.

the 60-90 minute bucket averaged 68,569 views/day, even with only 11 episodes in it. 90-120 averaged 18,235. 150+ averaged 12,827.

that means the shortest bucket beat the longest by 5.35x.

Threads takeaway:

cut your writing "final cut" by 20%. 6/9



32 1 1 2

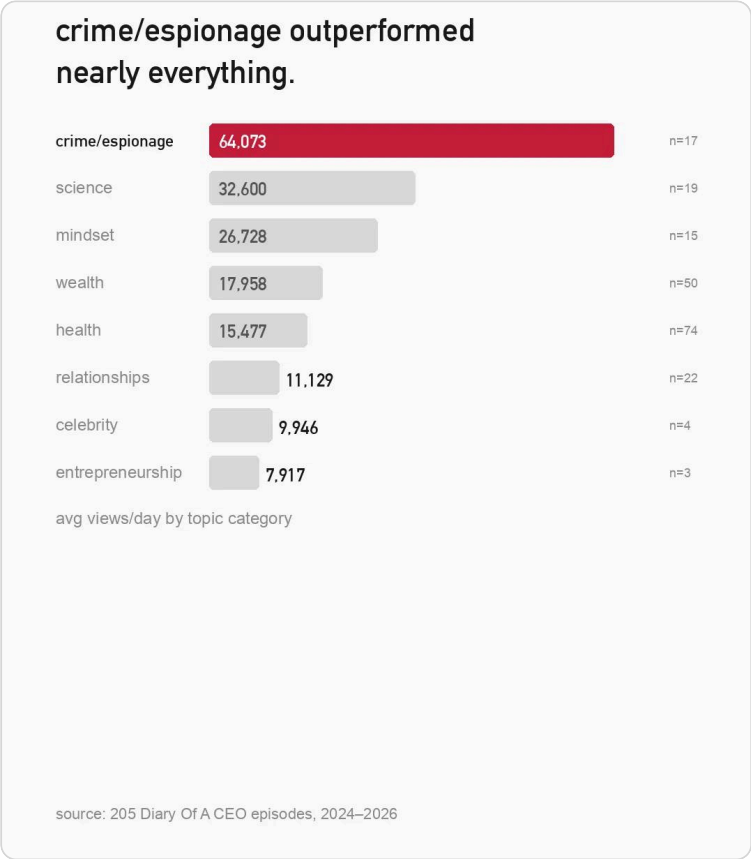
lennox_saint 03/22/26

6. topic framing mattered more than most creators think.

crime/espionage episodes averaged 64,073 views/day. health averaged 15,477. wealth averaged 17,958. same channel, same host, but the hidden-conflict frame pulled 4.14x health.

Threads takeaway:

even in boring niches, package the post around secrecy, stakes, conflict, or consequences. 7/9



29 4 1

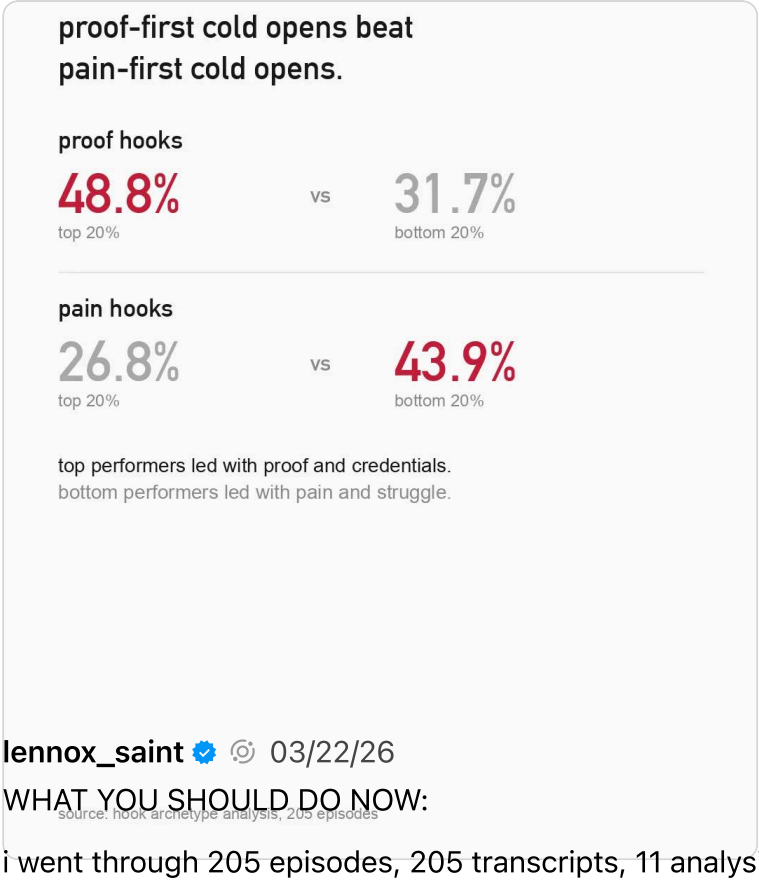
lennox_saint 03/22/26

7. pain-first hooks lost to proof-first hooks.

proof cold opens showed up in 48.8% of top videos, but only 31.7% of bottom videos. pain hooks did the reverse: 26.8% of top videos vs 43.9% of bottom videos. viewers clicked for receipts, not just emotion.

Threads takeaway:

open with evidence, demonstration, or a hard claim before you open the wound. 8/9



lennox_saint 03/22/26

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO NOW:

i went through 205 episodes, 205 transcripts, 11 analysis reports, and 5 constitutions for this.

the patterns are pretty clear: fame pulls clicks, proof beats pain, and titles do more work than most creators think.

follow @lennox_saint if you want more data-backed breakdowns like this <3 9/9

73 5 4

Pinned

lennox_saint 03/23/26 · Author

and if you wanna write posts like this ~

join 736+ thriends using Threadify.

writing + AI growth coach + replies + swipe file of 700+ viral posts with 1K+ likes + unlimited free scheduling

get started free - no card required:

threadify.app/plans...